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4.1 Choosing an IEP and Accreditation

Focus Questions:

- *What are some services that not all IEPs will have?*
- *What must IEPs offer in order to be accredited?*

Choosing an IEP

Virtually all IEPs will offer the following supports because they are required for accreditation:

- Student visa assistance
- New student orientation
- Accommodations assistance
- Immigration assistance
- Arrival and transportation assistance
- TOEFL, and/or IELTS preparation
- SAT, GRE, GMAT preparation
- University, academic, and career counseling

Students' ultimate choice of IEP may be decided by the English-language study services that distinguish them from other IEPs—in other words, not all IEPs will offer all of the following. For example:

- A good initial placement test
- A goals assessment
- Learning facilities and materials
- Grammatical accuracy training
- Listening and reading exercises
- Pronunciation work
- A certificate of completion or participation

- Transfer agreements if required with colleges or universities

All these elements should be investigated and understood by the student to come to an informed choice.

Accreditation

The US Department of Education recognizes three types of accreditation for IEPs. Programs that are under the governance of a college or university can be accredited through regional accrediting bodies for institutions of higher education. In addition, there are two other accrediting bodies for IEPs:

- **CEA** – *Commission on English Language Program Accreditation*: The Commission on English Language Program Accreditation (CEA), an accrediting body recognized by the US Department of Education, provides accreditation to post-secondary English language programs and institutions in the United States.
- **ACCET** – *Accrediting Council for Continuing Education and Training*: Recognized by the U.S. Department of Education since 1978, ACCET provides institutional accreditation for organizations offering continuing education.

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